UU-C-95B
May 31, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. UU-C-95A
August 16, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CARDS, GUIDE, FILE; AND CARD SETS, GUIDE, FILE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers manila and pressboard file guide cards and card sets.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, styles, classes and forms. File guide cards covered by this specification shall be of the types, styles, classes and forms as specified (see 6.2):

Type I. Calendered manila board.
  Style A. For drawer file.
    Class 1. Self tab.

Type II. Calendered pressboard.
  Style A. For drawer file.
    Class 1. Self tab.
    Class 2. Metal tab.
  Style B. For shelf file.
    Class 2. Metal tab.
  Style C. For vertical tray file.
    Class 1. Self tab.

Type III. Tabulating card stock.
  Style D. For data processing machines.
    Class 1. Self tab.

Form 1. Individual cards.
Form 2. Card sets.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 7530

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards:

T 402 - Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products.
T 403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 409 - Machine Direction of Paper.
T 410 - Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample. Guide cards in accordance with this specification shall conform favorably to the standard sample with respect to color, finish and cleanliness. Guide cards shall conform to the requirements of this specification in all other respects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2 Material. File guide cards shall be made from fibrous, cellulosic material which may include reclaimed fiber and shall conform to the requirements of this specification. Table I lists the physical characteristics to which the card material must conform. Type I guide cards shall be a calendered manila board, type II guide cards shall be a calendered pressboard, and type III guide cards shall be tabulating card stock.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Characteristic	Type I	Type II	Type III
Basis weight, 24 x 36-500, ± 5 percent, pounds	200	370	99
Thickness, inches	0.015 ± 0.0008	0.025 ± 0.0015	0.007 ± 0.0004
Bursting strength, minimum, pounds per square inch (psi)	110	225	55

3.3 Sizes. File guide cards shall be square cut to the sizes listed below (see 6.2). Sizes are exclusive of tabs and shelf hooks. The first number indicates the vertical dimension. A tolerance of plus or minus 1/16 inch shall apply.

Size in inches

Type I	Type II	Type III
3 x 5	7-3/8 x 3-1/4 (style C)	3-1/4 x 7-3/8
3-1/4 x 7-3/8	9-1/2 x 11-3/4 (styles A and B) (letter size)	
5 x 8		
6 x 8	9-1/2 x 14-3/4 (styles A and B) (legal size)	

3.3.1 Squareness. The guide file cards shall be considered square if the difference between the two diagonal measurements is not more than ± 1/32 inch for styles C and D or ± 1/16 inch for styles A and B.

3.4 Machine direction. The machine direction of the card material shall run vertically in the guide file cards.

3.5 Color. Types I and III guide cards shall be manila or buff. Type II guide cards shall be gray.

3.6 Styles.

3.6.1 Style A, drawer file. Style A guide file cards shall have the tab located along the long dimension of the card and shall be furnished in the following cuts and positions, as specified (see 6.2):

One-third cut, positions 1, 2, or 3.
One-fifth cut, positions 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5.

3.6.2 Style B, shelf file. Style B guide file cards shall have the tab located along the short dimension of the card and shall be furnished in one-third cut, center position only, unless otherwise specified.

3.6.2.1 Shelf hook. Style B cards shall have a metal shelf hook located along the edge opposite the tab. The metal and finish for the hook shall be the same as the tab. The hook shall be fastened to the card with a minimum of two eyelets. Dimensions for the fastened hook shall conform to figure 1.

3.6.3 Style C, vertical tray file. Style C guide file cards shall have the tab located along the short dimension and shall be furnished in one-half cut, first or second position or both positions, as specified (see 6.2).

3.6.4 Style D, data processing machine. Style D guide file cards shall have the tab located along the long dimension and shall be furnished in one-third cut, first, second or third position, as specified (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

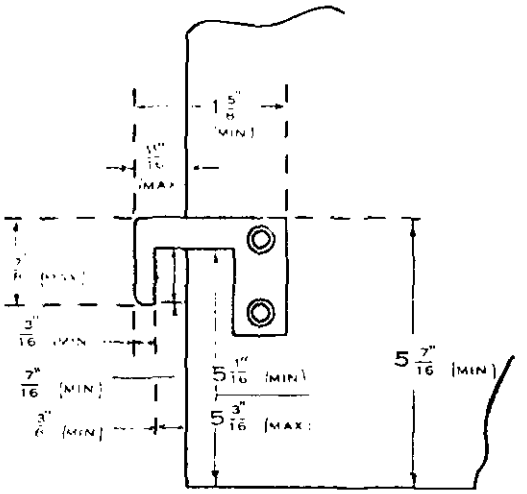


FIGURE 1 - DIMENSIONS FOR SHELF HOOK FASTENED TO STYLE B GUIDE CARDS

3.7 Classes.

3.7.1 Class 1, style A and C, self tab. Self tabs shall be 3/8 inch high for type I and type II, style C cards, and 1/2 inch high for type II, style A cards. A tolerance of ± 1/32 inch shall apply. The tabs shall be one-third or one-fifth cut, as specified (see 6.2). Tab corners shall be rounded.

3.7.2 Class 1, style D, self tab. Self tabs shall be 1/4 inch high for type III, style D. The tabs shall be of regular trapezoidal construction in which the base measures 1-1/4 inches wide and the opposite, parallel side is 1 inch wide. The tabs shall be one-third cut. The first and third position tabs will begin 1/32 inch in from the edge of the card. The second position tab shall be so located as to occupy the middle portion of the top edge of the card. A tolerance of ± 1/32 inch shall apply on all dimensions.

3.7.3 Class 2, metal tabs. Metal tabs shall be made of steel 0.0128 to 0.0141 inch thick (29 gage) finished as specified in 3.9. The tabs shall be fastened to the guide cards with a minimum of three eyelets through triangular-shaped gussets on both sides of the card. Metal tabs shall be so constructed that the inserts in 3.7.3.3 are held firmly in place within a window opening having the following dimensions:

Cut	Window opening, minimum, inches
1/3	3-1/2 x 3/8
1/5	1-3/4 x 3/8

The window opening in the long dimension shall be at least 3/8 inch shorter than the overall tab dimension in the same direction.

3.7.3.1 Class 2, style A. Metal tabs for style A cards shall be angled for increased visibility of the tab insert. The projecting height of the tab shall be a minimum of 5/8 inch. The maximum projecting height of the tab shall be such that the overall height of the guide card does not exceed 10-3/16 inches. The back of the tab projection shall be slotted to facilitate removal of the insert.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7.3.2 Class 2, style B. Metal tabs for style B cards shall be straight and shall have a full size window opening on both sides of the tab projection. The bottom (short dimension) of the tab projection shall be closed. The projecting width of the tab shall be such that the overall width of the guide card does not exceed 12-7/8 inches (letter size) or 15-7/8 inches (legal size).

3.7.3.3 Tab inserts. Each metal tab shall be furnished with a transparent (colorless) window of polymeric material. In addition, a blank white insert suitable for typewriting shall be furnished for each tab. The blanks shall be furnished in perforated strip form so that they may be easily detached from each other.

3.8 Sets.

3.8.1 Printed sets. When printed sets (form 2) are specified (see 6.2), type I, style A, class 1 guide cards with printed tabs or type II, style A, class 2, guide cards with printed tab inserts shall be furnished as follows:

Alphabetic (A through M, Mc, N through W, and XYZ)
1/5 cut, all positions, 25 cards per set.
Numeric (1 through 31), 1/5 cut, all positions, 31 cards per set.
Month (January through December), 1/3 cut, 2nd position, 12 cards per set.

All sets shall be collated.

3.8.1.1 Tab inserts. Printed tab inserts shall be furnished installed in the metal tabs.

3.8.2 Unprinted sets. Unprinted, one-third cut, and one-fifth cut guide cards shall contain 100 cards per set. All card sets shall be collated.

3.9 Finish. Metal tabs and hooks shall have a black, eggshell finish in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

3.10 Workmanship. Guide cards shall be free of defects which affect appearance or serviceability. On type II cards, the corners on the side with the tab shall be rounded. All corners of metal parts shall be rounded and there shall be no sharp projections or rough edges. Cards shall be free from wrinkles, scuffs, ragged or crushed edges, holes, blisters, tears or creases.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsiblity for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.2 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.3.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for the defects set forth in the applicable subparagraphs and at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) set forth in 4.3.1.5. The lot size in accordance with MIL-STD-105 shall be expressed in units of cards or card sets of the same type, style, class, size and tab positions offered for inspection at one time for examination in 4.3.1.1 and 4.3.1.2, in units of boxes for examination in 4.3.1.3, and in units of shipping containers for examination in 4.3.1.4.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

4.3.1.1 Examination of the end item for visual and constructional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one card or one card set, as applicable.

Examine	Defect
Type, class, style, form	Not as specified.
Color, finish, cleanliness	Does not compare favorably with standard sample.
Tabs	Not as specified.
Inserts	Missing or insufficient number. Wrong size.
Metal shelf hook	Not as specified.
Sets	All tab positions, as specified, not furnished. Not collated.
Alphabetic	Not A through M, Mc, N through W, XYZ. Not in sequence.
Numeric	Not 1 through 31. Not in sequence.
Month	Not January through December. Not in sequence.
Printing	Not as specified. Smudged, smeared, or illegible.
Workmanship	Wrinkles, scuffs, ragged or crushed edges, holes, blisters, tears or creases.

4.3.1.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one card or one card set, as applicble.

Examine	Defect
Types I, II, III	Horizontal and vertical dimensions not within tolerance.
Squareness	Difference between the two diagonals of types I, II, III, styles C and D more than ± 1/32 inch or more than ± 1/16 inch for type II, styles A and B.
Metal shelf hook	Dimensions and configuration not as specified.
Tabs	Not height specified. Not cut specified.

4.3.1.3 Examination of the end item for count. The sample unit for this examination shall be one package of cards or one card set, as applicable. When sets are furnished, the examination shall be to determine that sets are complete and collated. If the count for any package is less than specified, the lot shall be rejected unless the lot average for number per package is equal to or more than the specified quantity. If any package contains an uncollated set, the lot shall be rejected.

4.3.1.4 Examination of the end item for defects in preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that markings, materials, workmanship, and contents comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed. An equal number of shipping containers, fully prepared for delivery, shall be examined for closure defects in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Incorrect; incomplete; illegible; omitted; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any nonconforming components; component missing, damaged or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose or inadequate sealing, stapling, or strapping. Bulged or distorted container.
Contents	Number of boxes of cards per container is more or less than required.

4.3.1.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for examinations. The inspection levels for determining the sample size and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as defects per hundred units, shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQL
4.3.1.1	S-4	2.5
4.3.1.2	S-3	4.0
4.3.1.3	S-3	-
4.3.1.4	S-2	2.5

4.3.2 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested for the applicable characteristics in table II. The methods of testing listed in table II shall be followed. The lot size shall be expressed in boxes of guide cards of the same type, style, class and size submitted for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall consist of 5 guide cards and the inspection level, for the purpose of determining the sample size, shall be S-1. Test results shall include all values upon which the results are based and there shall be no failure to meet the sample unit or lot average requirements. Before testing all samples shall be conditioned according to TAPPI T 402.

TABLE II. Instruction for testing of the end item.

Characteristic	Specification reference paragraph	Test method	Application to Lot average	Number of determinations per sample unit	Pass/ fail	Results reported as numerically to nearest
Atmospheric conditions	4.3.2	T 402	All testing			
Basis weight	Table I	T 410	X	5		1 pound
Thickness	Table I	T 411	X	10		0.0001 in.
Bursting strength	Table I	T 403	X	10		1 psi
Machine direction	3.4	T 409	X	2	X	

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Guide cards of the same type, style, class, size, and tab position shall be packaged as specified below in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to type I or II of PPP-B-676; style II, type A, class a, or style VIII, type B of PPP-B-566.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.1 Type I. Twenty-five type I cards shall be banded with 50-pound (minimum) kraft paper, not less than 3 inches wide, and secured with tape or a suitable adhesive. The banded cards shall be packed one hundred (four banded packs) per box. Alternatively, cards shall be wrapped in thermoplastic film and heat sealed. When specified, one hundred cards shall be overwrapped with transparent polyethylene film. One complete printed set shall be banded in the same manner and packaged as follows:

Item	Sets per pkg.
Alphabetic set	4
Numeric set	3
Monthly set	8

5.1.1.2 Type II. Twenty-five type II, style A or B cards shall be packaged per box. Twenty-five type II, style C cards shall be banded as specified in 5.1.1.1 and packaged one hundred (four banded packs) per box. Printed alphabetical and numerical sets shall be packaged one set per box; monthly sets shall be banded and packaged two sets per box. Metal tabs and hooks shall be protected against splitting or crushing. Blank tab inserts shall be placed on the top guide card of each box.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Unit package.

5.1.2.1.1 Type I, calendered manila board. Unless otherwise specified, form 1 cards or form 2 sets of the style, class, size and tab position specified and assembled in accordance with 3.8.1 in quantities specified in table V shall be banded with paper, or wrapped in plastic film and sealed.

5.1.2.1.2 Type II, calendered pressboard. Unless otherwise specified, form 1 cards or form 2 sets of the style, class, size and tab position specified and assembled in accordance with 3.7.3.3, 3.8.1 or 3.8.1.1 in quantities specified in table V shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, type, style, variety and class optional.

5.1.2.1.3 Type III, tabulating card stock. Unless otherwise specified, form 1 cards of the style, class, size and tab position specified and assembled in quantities specified in table V shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type, class, style and variety optional. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II closure of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate packaging. Form 2 sets shall be intermediately packaged in quantities specified in table V in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676, or PPP-B-636, type, style, class and variety optional.

5.1.3 Level C. Cards and sets shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Cards, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, class weather-resistant, grade V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be waterproofed, closed, and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. Gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Military agencies. Cards, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety optional, or type SF, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Containers shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the container specification. Gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.2.2 Civil agencies.

5.2.2.2.1 Types I and II. Form 1 cards and form 2 sets in quantities specified in table V shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II closure of the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2.2.2 Type III. Form 1 cards do not require additional packing.

5.2.3 Level C. Cards and card sets in quantities as specified (see 6.2) packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination. Containers shall be in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

TABLE V Level B Packaging and Packing for Civil Agencies

Item		Size	Sets per pkg. box	Sets per intermediate box	Intermediate boxes per shipping container	Sets per shipping container
Form 1 cards	Type II	9-1/2 x 11-3/4				100
		9-1/2 x 14-3/4				100
Form 1 cards	Type III	3-1/4 x 7-3/8				2000
Form 2 sets						
Unprinted	Type I	3 x 5	1			50
		3-1/4 x 7-3/8	1	4	50	200
		3-1/4 x 7-3/8	1			18
		5 x 8	1			18
		6 x 8	1			18
	Type II	9-1/2 x 11-3/4				1
		9-1/2 x 14-3/4				1
Printed						
Alphabetic	Type I	3 x 5	1	4	50	200
		5 x 8	1	4	18	72
	Type II	9-1/2 x 11-3/4	1			20
		9-1/2 x 14-3/4	1			20
Monthly	Type I	3 x 5	1	8	50	400
Numeric	Type II	3 x 5	1	3	50	150
		5 x 8	1	3	18	54

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. File guide cards and card sets are intended for use in organization filing operations.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Form, type, style, and class of guide cards (see 1.2.1).
(c) Size of cards (see 3.3).
(d) Cut and tab position (see 3.6.1, 3.6.3, 3.6.4 and 3.7.1).
(e) Kind of set when form 2 is specified (see 3.8).
(f) Levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) When polyethylene overwrap is required (see 5.1.1.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:19
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 Standard sample. Standard samples may be obtained as directed by the procuring agency issuing the invitation to bid (see 3.1).

6.4 Military standards. Items procured under this specification for military use are to be limited to the variety shown on the applicable military supply standard. Personnel of the military department are requested to refer to these documents for guidance.

6.5 The Department of Defense waives coordination of this specification.

Military interest:

Army-GL

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 15 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.